

Taupō experience leads PGY1 to rural medicine

A positive three-month placement has inspired Maaike de Goede to pursue rural medicine.

PGY1 House Officer Maaike de Goede (Ngāti Maniapoto, Ngāti Hauā) enjoyed her three-month placement at Taupō Hospital so much that she now plans to specialise in rural medicine.

She says Taupō offers excellent support, and Clinical Director Dr Ralston D'Souza is creating an environment where people want to return.



Maaike de Goede, pictured left, with Dr Ralston D'Souza and her donated artwork.

Maaike recently completed her placement at Taupō Hospital and donated a piece of hand-woven artwork, which Dr D'Souza accepted on behalf of the hospital.

“This koha is a piece that was personally hand-woven. It depicts a pātiki, or flounder fish in English. The pātiki is an important pattern used in tukutuku and symbolises abundance, prosperity, manaakitanga and the community's ability to provide - all things that perfectly sum up Taupō Hospital.”

“I aim to work in rural medicine. I'm rural medicine to my core. I don't enjoy big hospitals. If I could sign up for longer than three months at Taupō Hospital, I would,” Maaike says.

Maaike chose to complete all her medical placements at Rotorua Hospital while studying medicine.

“In a smaller hospital, I get to know everyone - orderlies, kitchen staff - and there is no hierarchy. In Taupō, it's even better.”

“I felt accepted and fitted in as soon as I arrived. I swim in the lake every week with the Clinical Nurse Manager, then go for croissants and coffee with people in the community.”